Usually the Micro-Mesh range is sufficient. Cut your Micro-Mesh to fit the work being done and mark the back of smaller pieces

I usually use the fine abrasive products to get a sheen. When I do use any finish, it is a wicking in oil

## Display

For the 75mm bowls, you'll display them as you would larger works. They take up far less space, but can be laid out and handled much like any other turning. Smaller items may take some special care: not only are they more fragile, but are also prone to being lost. Setting them out on the club show and tell table is a recipe for disaster. You'll probably want to put them into a protective package of sorts. There are plastic display cases of a various sizes that work well to contain your turning, allowing for examination but protecting from rough handling or loss.

Depending on their size, the clear plastic tubes for displaying and shipping pens will work. You can easily cut them down in length to the correct size, allowing you to still use the press in top. Another method to secure miniature turnings is to use gel capsules. Intended for medication, these are clear, small and can be handled easily. The gel caps can then be pressed into a slotted block of wood, so that you can carry dozens of turnings in your shirt pocket.

Plastic pen tubes can be cut down with an Xacto knife to create carrying and display cases for turnings that could be easily lost or damaged

Some mini turnings from my collection. Tops and eggs created by artist Betty Scarpino

## Conclusions

If you haven't turned small and miniature, then just go for it. If you have a lathe, smallish tools, and some basic workholding devices, you have what you need to start into small work and miniatures. Will you be able to turn 2mm tall goblets with captive rings on your 60 year old bowl lathe? Perhaps not, but you can begin with what suits your limitations and then progress from there.

Is there an ideal lathe to do small turnings? I suggest that if you can hold the work and present your tools as needed on a lathe that is aligned properly, you have everything you need. Don't use 'I don't have [fill-in-the-blank]' as your excuse to not begin. Turning smaller work and even miniatures can open a whole new horizon for you.

Take the challenge of downsizing your work: if you typically turn 610mm bowls, try downsizing to 50mm bowls. Once you succeed at those or if you are already turning 50mm bowls, have a go at 6mm bowls. Not only will you be able to stretch your materials budget, but depending on how much you downsize your work, you may be able to carry your past year's turnings in a paper cup. If you don't begin the journey, you'll never get there will you? Give yourself the challenge to try turning 'small'. ●

Regardless of the size of your lathe, tools, or typical work, see how easily you can create a pocket full of turnings



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